

Rain Garden Observation Notebook

Compare drainage time in three soil samples. Record what happened before deciding why.

In this fictional classroom investigation, three equal containers hold sand, garden soil and clay-rich soil. Each receives the same water volume; students time the first 100 mL collected.

Sample	Trial Times	Median
Sand	38 / 41 / 40 sec	40 sec
Garden soil	84 / 90 / 87 sec	87 sec
Clay-rich soil	165 / 172 / 168 sec	168 sec

Keep the Test Fair

Use the same container size, water volume and timing method. Repeat each sample three times. Describe any spills or delayed starts.

Read the Pattern

Sand drained fastest in the sample results. The test measures this setup only; it does not establish how an entire garden will behave.

Ask a Better Question

How would compaction change the result? Plan one change at a time and state which measurement would answer your question.

Next Observation _____

Synthetic classroom observations · Follow your teacher's safety instructions.